

SENATE RESOLUTION 122

By Lowe

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the 100<sup>th</sup> anniversary of the passage of the Education Act of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pride in the storied history of the Volunteer State and events that have proven to be pivotal points in the advancement of the quality of life for Tennesseans; and

WHEREAS, on April 16, 1925, Governor Austin Peay signed into law Public Chapter 115 of 1925, commonly known as the Education Act of Tennessee, which established our first uniform system of public schools; and

WHEREAS, at the time Governor Peay took office in 1923, adult illiteracy was high in Tennessee, and our educational system ranked last in teacher salaries and forty-third in per pupil expenditures; and

WHEREAS, a comprehensive piece of legislation, the Education Act of Tennessee established a state salary schedule, set standardized licensing requirements for teachers, and created an equalization fund that guaranteed an eight-month school year in public elementary schools; and

WHEREAS, the legislation also increased funding for the University of Tennessee and led to the establishment of the University of Tennessee at Martin and Austin Peay State University; and

WHEREAS, one hundred years later, it is highly appropriate that we pause in our deliberations to specially recognize the anniversary of that historic event; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we commemorate the 100<sup>th</sup>

anniversary of the passage of the Education Act of Tennessee, honoring the legacy of Governor Austin Peay and the establishment of Tennessee's uniform system of public schools.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.